OAVS TGT - Current Affairs

Part 7: SCHEMES, POLICIES & MISCELLANEOUS

Expected questions with answers & explanations
based on PYQ pattern analysis (2019, 2022, 2023, 2024)

Schemes, policies, reports, anniversaries and defence news roughly Sep 2025 - Oct 2026. Facts verified as of 28 Oct 2026.

21 MCQs | 2 topics | star = very high probability

Question Pattern - Schemes & Miscellaneous

Syllabus: *Current Affairs (30 marks) - recent developments in Sports, Awards, Politics, Finance & Banking, International happenings, etc.* Across the five papers analysed, scheme, report and miscellaneous items typically contribute 2-4 questions per paper. The recurring question types are:

Question type	Typical form	How to prepare
Schemes	Full form, ministry, outlay, launch date	Learn the 2026 approvals with numbers
Census & reports	Phases, dates, India rank in an index	Rank, score and top country of each report
Anniversaries & books	Author of a book, 150 years of a national song	Who/what/when for each
Defence	Exercise name, partner country, location	Partner country and venue of each exercise

Strategy: most questions ask the full form, ministry, outlay or date of a scheme. Prioritise starred questions and the Rapid-Revision table at the end.

Contents

1. Government Schemes & Policies (12 MCQs)
2. Reports, Days, Defence & Miscellaneous (9 MCQs)
3. Rapid-revision table

1. Government Schemes & Policies

Why it matters: Scheme questions ask the full form, ministry, outlay or launch date. Learn the 2026 approvals with their numbers.

KEY FACTS

• VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 (Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act): replaces MGNREGA 2005; guarantees 125 days of wage employment per rural household per year (MGNREGA: 100); notified 11 May 2026 and rolled out from 1 July 2026; Centre's 2026-27 allocation Rs 95,692 crore.

• SARTHAK-PDS (Scheme for Assistance in Ration Transport and Handling - Income with Automation in PDS): approved by the CCEA on 27 May 2026; Rs 25,530 crore outlay to March 2031; about 81.35 crore NFSA beneficiaries; AI/blockchain tools - ASHA (grievance), SAKSHAM (transport tracking), NIRMAL.

• Other cabinet approvals 2026: Modified UDAN (regional air connectivity) Rs 28,840 crore (27 Mar); Kamala and Kalai-II hydropower projects, Arunachal Pradesh, Rs 40,150 crore (8 Apr); BHAVYA Rasayan chemical parks Rs 3,030 crore (25 Jul); Samudra Manthan national offshore exploration mission Rs 84,084 crore (31 Jul); revamped Khelo India (1 Aug); SME Growth Fund Rs 10,000 crore (7 Oct).

• Census 2027 (India's 16th, first digital census, with caste enumeration approved by CCPA on 30 Apr 2025): Phase 1 houselisting 1 Apr - 30 Sep 2026 (each state a 30-day window, 15-day self-enumeration before); Phase 2 population enumeration in February 2027; about 30 lakh enumerators using mobile apps.

Practice questions

Q1. ★ The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 replaces which law?

(A) DAY-NRLM
(B) National Food Security Act
(C) MGNREGA, 2005
(D) Right to Education Act

Answer: (C) MGNREGA, 2005. It repeals MGNREGA from 1 July 2026.

Q2. ★ How many days of wage employment per rural household does the VB-G RAM G Act guarantee each year?

(A) 100
(B) 120
(C) 125
(D) 150

Answer: (C) 125. 125 days (MGNREGA guaranteed 100).

Q3. From which date was the VB-G RAM G Act rolled out nationwide?

(A) 2 October 2026
(B) 1 July 2026
(C) 1 April 2026
(D) 1 January 2026

Answer: (B) 1 July 2026. Notified 11 May 2026; effective 1 July 2026.

Q4. ★ SARTHAK-PDS is a scheme to modernise the:

(A) Public Distribution System
(B) Postal system
(C) Public health system
(D) Pension system

Answer: (A) Public Distribution System. Public Distribution System - Rs 25,530 crore until March 2031.

Q5. SARTHAK-PDS benefits about how many NFSA beneficiaries?

(A) 25 crore
(B) 55 crore
(C) 81 crore
(D) 120 crore

Answer: (C) 81 crore. About 81.35 crore people.

Q6. Which committee approved SARTHAK-PDS on 27 May 2026?

(A) NITI Aayog
(B) CCPA
(C) GST Council
(D) CCEA

Answer: (D) CCEA. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs chaired by PM Modi.

Q7. The Samudra Manthan mission, approved in July 2026 with Rs 84,084 crore, relates to:

(A) Ports
(B) Offshore oil and gas exploration
(C) Coastal tourism
(D) Fishing subsidies

Answer: (B) Offshore oil and gas exploration. National offshore exploration mission.

Q8. Modified UDAN, approved in March 2026 with Rs 28,840 crore, aims to improve:

(A) Railway speed
(B) Rural roads
(C) Regional air connectivity
(D) Metro rail

Answer: (C) Regional air connectivity. UDAN = Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik - regional connectivity.

Q9. BHAVYA Rasayan, approved in July 2026, is a scheme for:

(A) Chemical parks
(B) Pharma exports
(C) Textile parks
(D) Food parks

Answer: (A) Chemical parks. Chemical parks - Rs 3,030 crore.

Q10. ★ India's 16th Census will have its population enumeration phase in:

(A) October 2026
(B) January 2028
(C) April 2027
(D) February 2027

Answer: (D) February 2027. Phase 2: February 2027; Phase 1 (houselisting): 1 Apr - 30 Sep 2026.

Q11. ★ What is special about Census 2027?

(A) First census conducted by NITI Aayog
(B) First census with no houselisting
(C) First census after Independence
(D) First digital census with caste enumeration

Answer: (D) First digital census with caste enumeration. Data collected on mobile apps by about 30 lakh enumerators; caste counted electronically.

Q12. The decision to include caste enumeration in the Census was approved on 30 April 2025 by the:

(A) Supreme Court
(B) Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs
(C) Lok Sabha Speaker
(D) Election Commission

Answer: (B) Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs. CCPA; caste was last fully counted by the British (1881-1931).

2. Reports, Days, Defence & Miscellaneous

Why it matters: Miscellaneous items: rankings, anniversaries, national symbols and defence exercises come up as 1-2 questions per paper.

KEY FACTS

• Global Hunger Index 2026: India ranked 100th of 122 countries, score 24.1 ('serious' category); Pakistan 25.5, Afghanistan 28.6, Bangladesh 19.2, Nepal 14.5 (scores).

• 150 years of Vande Mataram: written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee in 1875 (Akshaya Navami); PM Modi inaugurated the year-long commemoration on 7 Nov 2025 (to 7 Nov 2026) with a commemorative stamp and coin; the song first appeared in his novel Anandamath.

• Defence: AUSTRAHIND 2026 (5th edition India-Australia army exercise) 19 Oct - 1 Nov 2026 at Thiruvananthapuram (Garhwal Rifles); SWAVLAMBAN 2026 (Navy's innovation and indigenisation seminar, 5th edition) 26-27 Oct 2026, New Delhi; India to host first SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum by end-2026 (announced by Rajnath Singh, 20 Oct 2026).

• VP C. P. Radhakrishnan launched books in 2026 on Sree Narayana Guru and on Atal Bihari Vajpayee; Shivraj Singh Chouhan's book Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav was also launched.

Practice questions

Q13. ★ India's rank in the Global Hunger Index 2026 was:

(A) 76th of 125
(B) 100th of 122
(C) 105th of 127
(D) 111th of 125

Answer: (B) 100th of 122. 100th of 122 countries; score 24.1 (serious).

Q14. In the Global Hunger Index 2026, which neighbour scored better (lower) than India?

(A) Pakistan
(B) Afghanistan
(C) Nepal
(D) None

Answer: (C) Nepal. Nepal (14.5) and Bangladesh (19.2); Pakistan 25.5 and Afghanistan 28.6 were worse.

Q15. ★ The national song Vande Mataram was composed by:

(A) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee
(B) Muhammad Iqbal
(C) Subramania Bharati
(D) Rabindranath Tagore

Answer: (A) Bankim Chandra Chatterjee. Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, in 1875; it appears in Anandamath.

Q16. PM Modi launched the year-long 150th anniversary commemoration of Vande Mataram on:

(A) 15 August 2025
(B) 7 November 2025
(C) 26 January 2026
(D) 2 October 2025

Answer: (B) 7 November 2025. 7 November 2025 (Akshaya Navami), New Delhi.

Q17. Vande Mataram first appeared in which novel?

(A) Devdas
(B) Durgeshnandini
(C) Gora
(D) Anandamath

Answer: (D) Anandamath. Anandamath (1882), Bankim Chandra Chatterjee.

Q18. ★ AUSTRAHIND 2026 is a joint army exercise between India and:

(A) Austria
(B) Australia
(C) Armenia
(D) Austria and Hungary

Answer: (B) Australia. Australia - 5th edition, Thiruvananthapuram, 19 Oct - 1 Nov 2026.

Q19. SWAVLAMBAN is an annual seminar of the Indian:

(A) Air Force
(B) Army
(C) Navy
(D) Coast Guard

Answer: (C) Navy. Navy - innovation and indigenisation; 2026 edition held 26-27 Oct, New Delhi.

Q20. India will host the first Civilisational Dialogue Forum of which grouping (announced October 2026)?

(A) SCO
(B) G20
(C) BRICS
(D) ASEAN

Answer: (A) SCO. The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO), announced by Rajnath Singh in Dushanbe.

Q21. The book 'Apnapan: Narendra Modi Sang Mere Anubhav' is authored by:

(A) Smriti Irani
(B) Rajnath Singh
(C) Amit Shah
(D) Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Answer: (D) Shivraj Singh Chouhan. Shivraj Singh Chouhan, Union Agriculture Minister.

3. Rapid-Revision Table

Event	Answer
VB-G RAM G Act	**Replaces MGNREGA; 125 days; in force 1 Jul 2026**
SARTHAK-PDS	**Rs 25,530 cr; CCEA 27 May 2026; to Mar 2031; 81.35 cr people**
Samudra Manthan	**Offshore exploration; Rs 84,084 cr (31 Jul 2026)**
Modified UDAN	**Rs 28,840 cr (27 Mar 2026)**
BHAVYA Rasayan	**Chemical parks; Rs 3,030 cr (25 Jul 2026)**
SME Growth Fund	**Rs 10,000 cr (7 Oct 2026)**
Census 2027	**16th; first digital; houselisting 1 Apr-30 Sep 2026; enumeration Feb 2027**
GHI 2026	**India 100th/122; score 24.1**
Vande Mataram 150	**7 Nov 2025 - 7 Nov 2026; Bankim Chandra, 1875**
AUSTRAHIND 2026	**5th edition, Thiruvananthapuram, 19 Oct-1 Nov**
SWAVLAMBAN 2026	**Navy seminar, 26-27 Oct, New Delhi**

Check before exam: scheme rules, exercise dates and report rankings can change after 29 Oct 2026 - re-check them close to the exam.

Sources

- Open Magazine, Asianet Newsable - SARTHAK-PDS
- Rural Voice - VB-G RAM G Act notification
- Indian Masterminds - cabinet approvals 2026
- Free Press Journal, Drishti IAS - Census 2027
- Free Press Journal, Careers360 - Global Hunger Index 2026
- Daily Pioneer, IANS - 150 years of Vande Mataram
- SSB Crack Exams - defence current affairs 21 Oct 2026; Gknow - books and authors